

SAAD HASSAN

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate with hands-on penetration testing experience across web, API, and network assessments for banking and financial clients. Skilled in application security testing, source code review, and vulnerability assessment aligned with OWASP Top 10 and API Security Top 10. Holds eCPPTv3 and eJPTv2 certifications with active HackTheBox practice spanning Easy to Insane difficulty. Looking to contribute as a Security Engineer or Penetration Tester in a team that values practical, hands-on security work.

EDUCATION

FAST NUCES

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity
September 2021 – June 2025 | Karachi, Pakistan

- Teaching Assistant – Linear Algebra (2023–2024)

COURSEWORK

- Operating Systems
- Ethical Hacking, Digital Forensics
- Secure Software Design
- Information Security, Network Security, AI and Cybersecurity
- Malware Analysis, Vulnerability Assessment and Reverse Engineering
- Cloud Security

SKILLS

Tools: Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit, Ghidra, Nikto, IDA, Volatility, FTK Imager, Git, Postman

Languages: C/C++, Python, Bash

Frameworks: OWASP Top 10, OWASP API Security Top 10, NIST, CIS Benchmarks

Familiar With: PowerShell, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Docker, Kubernetes, Assembly (x86), JavaScript, PHP, HTML, CSS, SQL, Checkmarx, GitHub Advanced Security

Hard Skills: Web & API Penetration Testing, Network Penetration Testing, Active Directory Security, SAST/DAST/SCA Testing, Source Code Review, Vulnerability Assessment, OWASP Top 10, Auth/AuthZ Testing, SQLi, XSS, IDOR, SSRF, RCE, Business Logic Flaws, JWT Analysis, Python/Bash Scripting, Reporting and Remediation

Soft Skills: Accountability, Leadership, Cross-functional Collaboration

CERTIFICATIONS

- eCPPTv3** – eLearnSecurity Certified Professional Penetration Tester
- eJPTv2** – eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester, INE
- CNSP** – Certified Network Security Practitioner, The SecOps Group
- CTI 101** – Cyber Threat Intelligence, arcX
- API Penetration Testing** – APIsec University

EXPERIENCE

THINCSCORP

Threat Hunting Intelligence and Research Intern | July 2024 – November 2024

- Analyzed SolarWinds SUNBURST attack TTPs and produced detailed threat intelligence reports.
- Performed dynamic malware analysis using Cuckoo Sandbox to extract behavioral IOCs.

COMMTEL

Trainee Engineer – Information Security (Penetration Testing) | November 2025 – January 2026

- Conducted vendor-side penetration testing of banking systems, financial applications, web platforms and APIs, including reconnaissance, vulnerability scanning, and auth/authz testing aligned with OWASP Top 10.
- Performed API and web security testing for access control, input validation, and common misconfigurations; assisted with source code reviews to identify security weaknesses.
- Documented vulnerabilities with clear observations, impact assessment, and remediation guidance; collaborated with senior engineers and cross-functional teams on testing engagements.
- Assisted in developing compliance-aligned reports referencing NIST and CIS benchmark controls.

PROJECTS

MACHINE LEARNING FOR MISBEHAVIOR DETECTION IN VANETS

| Final Year Project | September 2024 – May 2025

Developed a machine learning model using the Random Forest algorithm to detect False Data Injection (FDI) attacks in Vehicular Ad-Hoc Networks (VANETs), achieving 98% accuracy on Kaggle's 'Veremi Extension FDI' dataset. Demonstrates hands-on experience with AI/ML-based threat detection and autonomous systems security

RANSOMWARE SIMULATOR | Malware Analysis Course Project

Developed a simulated ransomware using Fernet and RSA encryption to lock victim files, with persistence via startup folder and registry run keys.

PRIVACY ENHANCING TOOL

Created a Flask-based privacy website with steganography and EXIF data removal; applied secure coding practices and input sanitisation.

PACKET ANALYZER

Python + Scapy-based tool for real-time packet sniffing and analysis.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Runner-up – Procom (FAST Flagship Tech Event)
- Runner-up – DevDay (FAST Hackathon)

COMPETITIONS

- Top 25 in Pakistan on HackTheBox (middlebro77) — 19 systems compromised across Easy to Insane difficulty.
- Ranked in the top 1% on TryHackMe (0xSaadHassan) with 303 completed rooms, participating in CTF events and red vs. blue team exercises across OWASP Top 10 and network security attack vectors.